emotional echoes that do not match his “serf” life.

- Late game: Full reconstruction of the origin becomes both personal revelation and political dynamite against the French crown and the Duchy of Breyzh.

This version keeps the Crown genuinely ignorant of the swap until the decisive test, gives them a period of actually raising him, explains the memory wipe + false serf past, preserves the “only pureblood MAGICK is inheritable → dosing required” rule, and turns the parental-memory ability into a clean investigative and emotional tool for the player.

> ok i think we need start defining what MAGICK is. In my vision its something similar to the X-Men mutation thing. However this thing is made artificially, the power/abilities range given are classified by hierarchy, and we also need to fit this thing with the Church's authority and scepticsm in tech

Worked for 6s ›

MAGICK – Core Definition

MAGICK is **artificially induced genetic mutation**, deliberately engineered and stratified by the great houses and the French crown. It is not a natural evolution or random gift. It is a controlled technology of the body, framed and policed so that it reinforces the existing hierarchy rather than threatening it.

Nature of MAGICK

- It functions like X-Men-style mutations: the body is rewritten at the genetic and epigenetic level to produce superhuman abilities (enhanced strength, regeneration, sensory dominance, limited environmental manipulation, accelerated healing, etc.).
- Unlike natural mutation, every package is **designed, manufactured, and administered**. There is no “wild” MAGICK that simply appears. What looks spontaneous is almost always the delayed expression of an earlier, hidden intervention (as with the hero).
- Stability, potency, and inheritance are strictly graded:
  - **Pureblood royal packages** (royal + royal): the only form that is naturally inheritable across generations. Clean, powerful, and politically legitimized.
  - **High noble packages**: strong but usually require reinforcement or are only partially heritable.
  - **Knight / retainer packages**: functional combat and enforcement tools, rarely passed on cleanly.
  - **Serf packages**: narrow, productivity-focused (endurance, toxin resistance, rapid recovery from labor, sometimes heightened pain tolerance or compliance). Explicitly non-inheritable and non-threatening. Must be re-dosed each generation.

Lower ranks cannot simply “awaken” high MAGICK. The yearly collections and forced injections exist precisely because the hierarchy refuses to let stable power exist outside pure bloodlines.

Church framing and control

The Church does not reject MAGICK. It claims ownership of its meaning.

- Official doctrine: MAGICK is a **divine endowment** mediated through legitimate blood and sacramental authority. The purest expressions are signs of God’s favor upon the rightful order. The dosing of serfs is presented as a merciful “gift of strength for honest labor.”
- The Church maintains its own gene-foundries and inquisitorial auditors. They decide which packages are “orthodox” and which are heretical or demonic.
- Any MAGICK that appears outside approved channels (especially in serfs or mixed-blood individuals) is declared either a miracle requiring investigation or a corruption requiring purification/excision.
- Technological language is deliberately suppressed in public. The Church prefers terms such as “blood grace,” “sacred endowment,” or “the Mark of Station.” Speaking of MAGICK as mere genetic engineering is treated as dangerous skepticism or outright heresy.

This allows the Church to remain the moral and ritual authority while still fully participating in (and profiting from) the system.

Skepticism toward “tech”

Openly technological framing is politically toxic.

- The great houses and the Crown present MAGICK as an extension of ancient blood right, not as laboratory product.
- Independent medical centres, unlicensed gene-work, or talk of “engineering” are associated with the pre-collapse world that “failed.” The destruction of the centre that enabled the hero’s origin is both practical cover-up and ideological statement.
- Skeptics who insist MAGICK is just advanced biotechnology are marginalized, accused of undermining the sacred hierarchy, or quietly removed.
- In private, of course, the houses run highly sophisticated laboratories. The public face remains theological and hierarchical.

Practical consequences for the setting

- A person’s legal and social value is partly measured by the grade of MAGICK they carry or are permitted to receive.
- Detection systems at checkpoints, coming-of-age rites, and yearly collections constantly sort bodies according to the approved hierarchy.
- Unlicensed or mismatched MAGICK (exactly what the hero carries) is both a practical threat and a theological scandal.
- The Church’s blessing is required for high-grade packages; without it, even a powerful ability can be declared illegitimate.

This definition keeps MAGICK feeling like X-Men mutation in the moment of power fantasy, while